

1938, December 15

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

Rev. M. E. Joachim Casey, page 2.

diocese, to a prelate you've possibly never met and who has possibly never heard of Father Joachim. Naturally you would hope to be received with open arms, --dreaming as you probably do, of some cozy little place just smiling across the Wisconsin hills at you. Ah dear Fr. Maurice Joachim! You may be sure, such would be only dreaming. Your age and your experience should rather exclude such dreams as belonging to the long ago. This we might think especially, considering your years of dreaming when and how you might get away from the world to a monastery. Think of it, dear Father Joachim

Nearly five and thirty years back, while still in the mail service, you wrote on the feast that since has become your own name-day: ".....This is my plan' and I want you to let me know what you think of it. ".....I'll try it out for a year or so and if it goes then I'll join yours or some other holy order. If it don't go, I'll be a lay-brother. And if that fails, then by George I'll get married and go out West and be as useful to God and man as I can, a secular I'll never be." You wrote that from Prairie Avenue, Chicago. I showed your letter to dear, old Father Bonaventure, ex-Provincial at the time, and Fr. Superior in Yonkers, where I was stationed (for 14 years following). May his dear soul rest in peace. He was pleased with your letter and said: "...He has good intentions. Tell him to go ahead.." The next letter I received from you, you were back in college after twenty years vacation. This time in Berlin--now Kitchener--Ontario. Your handwriting on the envelope presaged your sentiments within: "...I have found the peace again I looked for so long, and in this I feel amply repaid for the sacrifice it took to give up everything."

What a practical experience,--a grace to convince you that sacrifice willingly made for God's sake is always a small sacrifice for results sure to follow. Deo Gratias!

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Dear Brother --Dear Father M. J. : You've long since wanted to be a real missionary. So has your brother whom you have led (according to age, three years in advance) wished to be indeed a missionary...When are we to start? Whither shall we turn to find a field wherein our zeal will be profitable to souls and appreciated? Shall we go to the ends of the earth, or shall we, convinced that Charity, rightly ordered, begins at home? Shall we begin right in our own hearts?